

Executive Brief

Delta tracked edition · 12 new, 1 moved, 7 carrying over

Edition **EDITION-003**

2026-09-19

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12 New items	7 Carrying over	1 Contested	0 Settled / terminal
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0 · What Changed Since Yesterday

Compared against **EDITION-002**. 12 new, 1 moved, 7 carrying over

Changed state (1)

Item	Section	Was	Now
AI-generated intimate images fall inside the criminal definition	EUREKA	NEW	OPEN

New today (12)

Item	Section	Was	Now
The exact list of Sarawak laws PETRONAS is asking the Federal Court to strike down	SITUATION	—	NEW
Brent at about USD 104 - up 14 per cent in a month and 56 per cent in a year	SITUATION	—	NEW
The Fed raised rates on 16 September - first hike since 2023	SITUATION	—	NEW
Carigali's new 35-year PSC for Block A-18-01, approved on 14 September	SITUATION	—	NEW
PETRONAS 1H 2026: revenue up 15 per cent, production down 61 thousand boe a day	SITUATION	—	NEW
The haze now has an operating threshold, and it has been used once this year	VOID	—	NEW
Sarawak must go to the polls by April 2027, and the polls decide who negotiates the petroleum question	VOID	—	NEW
Pump prices up 35 sen for 17-23 September while the subsidised grade is held	RISK	—	NEW
The most sensitive dark matter detector in the world has one unexplained event	EUREKA	—	NEW
Diplodocus has been found outside North America for the first time	EUREKA	—	NEW
BepiColombo reached Mercury after eight years and cut its engine loose	EUREKA	—	NEW
The revenue environment moved this month; the departure window did not	OWN	—	NEW

Carrying over unchanged: 7 item(s). Not repeated in full — see the open-items register.

0.1 · Standing Instructions

Derived from your own comments on earlier editions. Each shows the words it came from. A rule you no longer want can be retired; it is listed here so it cannot operate invisibly.

Instruction	Standing since	Editions
Buang naratif politik. Fokus pada OD1. heard as: “Buang naratif politik. Fokus pada OD1.”	2026-09-18	1

Situation

The exact list of Sarawak laws PETRONAS is asking the Federal Court to strike down NEW

PETRONAS's petition BKA-1-01-2026(W) is not a general challenge. It names Sarawak's Environment (Reduction of Greenhouse Gases Emission) Ordinance 2023, the Sarawak Land (Carbon Storage) Rules 2022, sections 7, 7A and 8 of the Distribution of Gas Ordinance 2016, the Oil Mining Ordinance 1958 and the 1954 boundary order that pulls the continental shelf into the definition of State land. Leave was granted on 16 March 2026 and the judgment was recorded on 30 April 2026. Carbon storage regulation in Sarawak sits inside the scope, which is the part that touches the CCS chain directly.

Source: [2026] 4 MLRA 491, Federal Court, Hashim Hamzah CJM, Motion No BKA-1-01-2026(W) - https://www.elaw.my/JE/01/JE_2026_20.html

Whether LNG exported from Bintulu falls under PETROS or stays with PETRONAS CONTESTED

Still no document in the public record defines the boundary for the export molecule specifically. The commercial question cannot settle before the constitutional one does, and the constitutional one now has leave granted but no hearing date. Unchanged from Editions 001 and 002.

Source: Federal Court leave granted 16 March 2026; Sarawak petition filed 23 February 2026

Brent at about USD 104 - up 14 per cent in a month and 56 per cent in a year NEW

Brent settled at USD 104.16 on 18 September, a third consecutive daily fall, after Saudi Arabia started routing crude around the damaged Yanbu terminal and said it could restore half the East-West pipeline's capacity within days and full capacity within six weeks. This is a disruption premium rather than a demand move: Urals is at USD 121.61, gasoline is up 76 per cent year on year, and the near-month futures backwardation is doing the work. The falsification test is whether the bypass holds - shipping is already shifting through ship-to-ship transfers near Oman's Sohar port, which rose to 2.7 million barrels a day from 1.5 million in August.

Source: TradingEconomics Brent, 18 September 2026 (104.16 USD/bbl, +13.69% month, +56.21% year). Anti-thesis search run: 'Iran ceasefire September 2026 oil prices fall Hormuz reopened' - returns the April and June ceasefire rallies collapsing prices, i.e. the premium has unwound twice this year already, so 'oil is structurally high' is NOT supported.

The Fed raised rates on 16 September - first hike since 2023 NEW

The target range moved to 3.75-4.00 per cent on a 12-0 vote, with the committee naming oil-driven inflation in the statement itself and the Chair calling inflation too high for too long. Projections show another hike possible this year, none pencilled in for 2027, headline PCE at 3.7 per cent and unemployment at 4.1 per cent. The dollar is at 100.2 on the index while the ringgit sits at 4.098, so the pressure lands on the same side of the ledger as the oil price.

Source: CNBC, 16 September 2026 - <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/09/16/fed-rate-decision-september-2026.html> ; FOMC statement same date

Carigali's new 35-year PSC for Block A-18-01, approved on 14 September NEW

PC JDA, a wholly owned subsidiary of PETRONAS Carigali, and PTTEP JDX received Malaysian and Thai approval for a new PSC covering the existing Block A-18 plus an adjacent exploration area. The 35-year term runs from 1 January 2026 - before the current PSC expires on 20 April 2029 - and a Gas Sales Agreement was signed the same day. The joint development area covers 7,250 square kilometres across Blocks A-18-01 and B-17-01, with about 700 million standard cubic feet a day split equally between the two countries.

Source: PETRONAS statement 14 September 2026, via The Star - <https://www.thestar.com.my/business/business-news/2026/09/14/petronas-carigali-partners-secure-new-psc-for-mtjda-block-a-18-01>

PETRONAS 1H 2026: revenue up 15 per cent, production down 61 thousand boe a day NEW

Revenue came in at RM152.4 billion, up RM19.8 billion, with profit after tax of RM27.2 billion and capex of RM41.4 billion - the capex figure is inflated by the additional injection into PRefChem. Upstream output fell to 2,341 thousand barrels of oil equivalent a day from 2,402, which the company attributes to planned portfolio optimisation, asset transitions and the West Asia conflict. Twenty-five Final Investment Decisions were taken, seven projects delivered first hydrocarbons, and the Searah joint venture with ENI became effective on 1 June 2026 covering 19 assets at about 500 thousand boe a day.

Source: PETRONAS media release, 28 August 2026 - <https://www.petronas.com/media/media-releases/petronas-posts-resilient-half-year-results-remains-steadfast-safeguarding>

Budget 2027 tabled in Parliament, 9 October 2026 OPEN

Twenty-one days from this edition. The petroleum dividend line and the fuel subsidy line become checkable that day, and the pre-budget statement of 18 August set ten consultation focus areas without a single number attached to them. This is also the date the petroleum revenue projection below either acquires a source or does not.

Source: Ministry of Finance pre-budget statement - <https://www.mof.gov.my/portal/en/news/press-release/pre-budget-statement-2027>

Wall

Federal Court full hearing date on the PDA 1974 challenge - STILL UNRESOLVED OPEN

Leave was granted on 16 March 2026 and the judgment on that leave was recorded on 30 April, so the petition is live and has been canvassed. No date for the full hearing of either petition is in the public record. This is UNRESOLVED, not WITHDRAWN: the date is knowable and the court simply has not set it publicly. This item is what notices when it does.

Source: No full hearing date published as of this edition. Wall standing from Editions 001 and 002.

The RM10-20 billion petroleum revenue projection - STILL WITHDRAWN CONTESTED

The range still circulates without a filing behind it. Labelled CONTESTED rather than estimated, because an estimate carries a method and this carries a spread. The nearest verifiable neighbour is the RM20 billion dividend declared for 2026 -

the lowest in nine years - which is a different number measuring a different thing, and is not the same claim.

Source: No primary document located; range appears in secondary commentary only. Wall standing from Edition 002.

Void

The haze now has an operating threshold, and it has been used once this year NEW

A district in Sarawak was placed under a state of emergency on 4 September when its air reading passed 500 - the first such declaration of 2026 - and the emergency was lifted three days later. On 15 September, 38 areas were still reading unhealthy, with Johor carrying the most; Serian peaked at 188 and the Klang Valley ran above 150 from Cheras to Shah Alam to Putrajaya. The consequence is a work-planning fact before it is a health fact: the threshold in the standing instructions defines when field activity and school activity actually stop, and it has now been tested once this year.

Source: Department of Environment API readings via CNA, 15 September 2026 - <https://www.channelnewsasia.com/asia/haze-worsens-across-malaysia-38-areas-recording-unhealthy-air-quality-6385056>

Sarawak must go to the polls by April 2027, and the polls decide who negotiates the petroleum question NEW

The State Legislative Assembly's term expires in February 2027 and a poll must follow within 60 days unless the House is dissolved earlier; GPS has said it will contest all 82 seats and that 17 proposed new seats may not clear the Election Commission's timeline in time. The election therefore lands in the same window as the constitutional case, so whichever government is returned inherits the negotiating position rather than the current one. The Premier controls the date and has not named it.

Source: Sarawak Premier's Office, 2 September 2026; Free Malaysia Today, 19 April 2026 and 5 July 2026

RM13.3 billion of unclaimed money with the Accountant-General OPEN

Not a news item, which is exactly why it stays unknown: it is a register nobody markets. Verifiable by an individual in about a minute with an identity card. Structurally the same shape as any unclaimed entitlement - it belongs to someone who does not know it exists. Carried forward unchanged.

Source: Accountant-General unclaimed money register, January 2026

Nomination voiding silently on a change of marital status OPEN

A nomination made before a marriage is not automatically the nomination that applies after it, and the failure is silent - it is discovered by survivors. The fund has publicly corrected circulating messages on this, which is the reason to take it from the fund and not from a forwarded message. Carried forward unchanged.

Source: EPF public statements correcting viral nomination claims

The most sensitive dark matter detector in the world has one unexplained event NEW

LUX-ZEPLIN, ten tonnes of ultrapure liquid xenon a mile underground in South Dakota, found a single interaction in 220 live days of data that its own team cannot explain with known backgrounds. Significance is 2.6 sigma against the 5 sigma needed to claim a discovery, and the collaboration states plainly that it is not claiming dark matter. If it is real, the particle would be at least 200 times the mass of a proton.

Source: Berkeley Lab, 1 September 2026 - <https://newscenter.lbl.gov/2026/09/01/lz-sees-surprising-result-in-search-for-dark-matter/>

Diplodocus has been found outside North America for the first time NEW

Every confirmed Diplodocus since 1878 has come out of one formation in the western United States. Fourteen tail vertebrae and several chevron bones unearthed at La Tejeria near El Castellar in Teruel, Spain, belong to the genus - a 25-metre animal that lived about 150 million years ago, described in the Journal of Vertebrate Paleontology. It is the strongest evidence yet that dinosaurs moved between the two continents across temporary land bridges when the proto-Atlantic shallowed.

Source: EL PAIS, 15 September 2026 - <https://english.elpais.com/science-tech/2026-09-15/first-diplodocus-found-outside-north-america-discovered-in-spain.html>

BepiColombo reached Mercury after eight years and cut its engine loose NEW

The Mercury Transfer Module separated from the two science orbiters on 3 September 2026, ending an eight-year cruise that used flybys of Earth, Venus and Mercury itself because carrying enough fuel for a direct route was never possible. Two orbiters - one European, one Japanese - will now be inserted into different orbits to measure the planet from the inside out. Nothing built by humans has flown this close to the Sun for this long.

Source: European Space Agency mission updates - https://www.esa.int/Science_Exploration/Space_Science/BepiColombo/Latest_updates_BepiColombo_s_arrival_at_Mercury

AI-generated intimate images fall inside the criminal definition OPEN

The 2026 cybercrime amendments bring synthetically generated intimate images within the offence rather than leaving them outside it. Worth knowing before it is needed, because the person who needs it is usually already under attack when they find out. Carried forward unchanged from Edition 002.

Source: Cybercrimes Bill 2026, clause 24

Risk

Pump prices up 35 sen for 17-23 September while the subsidised grade is held NEW

RON97 moved to RM4.85, unsubsidised RON95 to RM4.37 and unsubsidised diesel to RM5.27 for the week, while subsidised RON95 stays at RM1.99 and BUDI diesel at RM2.10. The gap between RM4.37 and RM1.99 is the size of the position the government is carrying at these oil prices, and the Ministry of Finance

attributes the move to global prices. It is the number that moves first if the subsidy is revisited, ahead of any announcement.

Source: Ministry of Finance weekly automatic pricing mechanism schedule, 16 September 2026 - <https://mediaselangor.com/en/2026/09/396071>

Electricity protection threshold reverts 800 to 600 kWh on 1 January 2027 OPEN

The widened band is now formally dated from the government side: 800 kWh a month for domestic users, with the automatic fuel adjustment, retail charge and service tax suspended, applying to usage from September to 31 December 2026 and worth up to RM47 a month. It ends on 31 December and the baseline underneath it is 600 kWh. One hundred and five days from this edition, and December's consumption is the last one still covered.

Source: Prime Minister's announcement, 17 September 2026 - <https://www.nst.com.my/news/nation/2026/09/1534928/updated-electricity-subsidy-threshold-expanded-households-using-800kwh>

Own

The revenue environment moved this month; the departure window did not NEW

Three things changed inside thirty days: Brent moved from the high seventies into the low hundreds, PETRONAS restructured upstream assets and added a 35-year PSC through Carigali, and Revenue for the half came in 15 per cent above last year at RM152.4 billion. The window that decides the next move is still March 2027, and a number quoted against a soft-price outlook is now being quoted against a hard-price one. Nobody else is positioned to weigh those two facts against each other.

Source: Composite of the items above; each figure is individually sourced in this edition.